

Seung Deok Seo

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Education	University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign	United States
	Ph.D. in Political Science	2022 – Present
	Fields: Comparative Politics (major), International Relations (minor)	
	London School of Economics and Political Science	United Kingdom
	M.Sc. in Development Studies	
	Hankuk University of Foreign Studies (HUFS)	Republic of Korea
	B.A. in Arabic Interpretation and Translation; Minor in Political Science	
	<i>Study abroad: Cairo University (Egypt); University of Jordan (Jordan)</i>	
Working Papers	[1] Do Cross-National Aid Allocation Patterns Travel Sub-Nationally? Evidence from Saudi Aid Allocation in Indonesia (<i>with Paul Un; under review</i>)	
	[2] Together in Public, Apart in Practice: Credit Competition and Strategic Shallowness in Civil Society Cooperation (<i>Dissertation Project</i>)	
	[3] Whose Aid Is Trusted: Donor Identity and Religious Congruence in Egypt and Indonesia (<i>with Paul Un</i>)	
	[4] Staying Registered, Going Quiet: How Restrictive NGO Laws Suppress Civil Society Activity (<i>with Tae Il Kim</i>)	
Fellowships	Internal — University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign	
Grants & Awards	Graduate College Dissertation Travel Grant, \$5,000	2026
	Graduate Research and Professionalization Fund, \$2,000 (<i>with Paul Un</i>)	2026
	Graduate Research and Professionalization Fund, \$1,200 (<i>dissertation fieldwork</i>)	2026
	Evelyne Accad and Paul Vieille Research Award, \$1,000	2026
	Facilitating Learning Excellence Award for Teaching (<i>PS 241, PS 282</i>)	2025, 2026
	Departmental Travel and Training Support, \$800 total	2024–2026
	Illinois Global Institute Language Fellowship (Arabic), \$20,000	2024–2025
	Kneier Fellowship, \$3,927	2023
	External	
	IQMR Open Pool Fellowship, \$3,085	2026
	Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), \$3,000	2026
	IHS Graduate Papers Workshop, Honorarium and Travel Support, \$1,400	2026
	SICSS: Fully Funded (tuition and lodging)	2025
	ISA–Midwest: Conference Travel Grant, \$250	2024
	HUFS: Study Abroad Scholarship (<i>University of Jordan</i>), \$3,700	2015

Teaching Experience	Instructor of Record, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign	
	PS 201: U.S. Racial and Ethnic Politics (<i>online</i>)	Fall 2026
	Teaching Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign	
	PS 282: Governing Globalization — Discussion Leader	Spring 2026
	PS 241: Comparative Politics in the Global South — Discussion Leader	Fall 2025
	PS 322: Law and Public Policy	Spring 2024
	PS 250: Rise Up: Organizing Resistance	Fall 2023
Research Presentations	IHS Graduate Papers Workshop, University of Washington (<i>invited</i>)	2026
	— <i>on Civil Society and Political Economy</i>	
	American Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2026
	International Studies Association Annual Convention	2025, 2027 (forthcoming)
	International Studies Association–Midwest Annual Convention	2024, 2025
	Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference	2024
Fieldwork	Jordan: Dissertation fieldwork (<i>planned, October 2026–March 2027</i>)	
Training	Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR)	United States
	Qualitative Causal Inference; Process Tracing and Typological Theories	2026
	Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS)	Republic of Korea
	Text as Data; Machine Learning	2025
	Hebrew University of Jerusalem (Rothberg International School)	Israel
	Summer Course: The History of the Arab–Israeli Conflict	
	Bourguiba Institute of Modern Languages	Tunisia
	Arabic Language Training (Modern Standard Arabic)	
Professional Experience	Korea International Cooperation Agency (KOICA), Iraq Office	Iraq, Remote
	Development Cooperation Junior Consultant — Middle East / North Africa	2021
	UN Women, Palestine Country Office	Palestinian Territories
	Social Media and Youth Engagement Officer	2018–2020
Languages	Korean (native); English (fluent); Arabic (advanced — Modern Standard and Levantine)	
Skills	R, Python, $\LaTeX$, Qualtrics	